APEX INDUSTRIAL LOGISTICS LIMITED

Supply Chain & Logistics Solutions | India

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Managed Netw ork Transformation:

SD-WAN, Cloud Interconnects & Managed Security Operations

RFP Reference No.	AILL-PROC-2025-0078
Issuing Authority	Group IT Infrastructure & Procurement
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This document is issued solely for the purpose of soliciting proposals from qualified Managed Service Providers (MSPs) and System Integrators for the managed network transformation programme described herein. It does not constitute a commitment, representation, or warranty by Apex to enter into any contractual relationship. Apex reserves the absolute right, at its sole discretion, to:

- Accept or reject any or all proposals received in response to this RFP, without assigning any reason and without incurring any liability to any responding vendor;
- Cancel, modify, or re-issue this RFP at any time without prior notice;
- Waive any informality or irregularity in a proposal;
- Negotiate with one or more vendors simultaneously;
- Award a contract to a vendor whose proposal is not the lowest-cost submission;
- Conduct due diligence verification on all information submitted by responding vendors.

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> **NOTE: The submission of a proposal in response to this RFP does not entitle any vendor to reimbursement of costs incurred in the preparation of said proposal. All proposal preparation costs are borne exclusively by the responding vendor.**

SECTION 1 — Executive Summary and Introduction

1.1 About Apex Industrial Logistics Limited

Apex Industrial Logistics Limited (hereinafter "Apex" or "the Company") is one of India's leading integrated logistics and heavy supply chain operators. Founded in 1994 and headquartered in Bhiwandi, Maharashtra, Apex operates a national network of three hundred (300) branch warehouses spanning twenty-eight (28) Indian states and Union Territories, with a centralised Tier-III Data Centre located in Andheri East, Mumbai.

Apex employs approximately 15,000 personnel across its operational footprint and recorded consolidated annual revenue of approximately INR 5,500 Crore in Financial Year 2024–25. The Company's core business verticals encompass bulk freight forwarding, automated warehousing, cold-chain logistics, last-mile distribution, and cross-border trade facilitation. Apex is a publicly listed entity on the National Stock Exchange (NSE: APEXIL) and is subject to SEBI listing obligations.

1.2 Current Infrastructure Challenges and Business Drivers

Apex's current enterprise network infrastructure was architected over a decade ago and is now a material constraint on operational agility, application performance, and security posture. The incumbent environment presents the following critical and unacceptable constraints:

Pain Point	Current Impact on Operations
Legacy MPLS Network	All 300 branch warehouses are connected via legacy Multiprotocol Label Switching (MPLS) circuits procured from a single incumbent carrier. Bandwidth tiers are rigid (2 Mbps to 10 Mbps per branch), costly to upgrade, and require 60–90-day lead times for any configuration change.
Chronic Network Outages	The Company experienced an average of 4.3 unplanned network outages per month per region in FY2024–25, each lasting an average of 47 minutes. These outages directly halt warehouse management system (WMS) operations, fleet tracking updates, and ERP transaction processing, resulting in an estimated revenue impact of INR 3.8 Crore per month.
Single-Link Dependency	Hub warehouse sites (Tier-1) currently operate on a single MPLS link with no active failover path. Loss of connectivity at a hub site cascades to 8–15 dependent spoke sites reliant on the hub for WMS access and IoT aggregation.
No Cloud On-Ramp	Apex is executing a cloud-first transformation programme (ERP on Microsoft Azure, data analytics on AWS). Currently, all cloud traffic is backhauled through the Mumbai Data Centre, introducing latency of 180–340 ms for branch-to-cloud workloads and consuming disproportionate Data Centre bandwidth.
Security Perimeter Gaps	Branch sites lack next-generation firewall (NGFW) protection. A significant ransomware incident in Q3 FY2024 resulted in operational downtime of 72 hours across 14 warehouse sites and a forensic investigation cost of INR 1.1 Crore. Apex currently has no 24/7 Security Operations Centre (SOC) capability.
IoT Connectivity Fragmentation	Apex operates a fleet of 2.5 million IoT-enabled tracking SIMs across its vehicle fleet and warehouse assets. SIM management is currently distributed across three different Mobile Virtual Network Operators (MVNOs), resulting in fragmented visibility, inconsistent data plans, and inability to enforce unified MDM policies.

1.3 Programme Objectives

Apex Industrial Logistics Limited hereby issues this Request for Proposal to solicit proposals from qualified Managed Service Providers and System Integrators for the complete overhaul of its enterprise network, cloud connectivity, and security infrastructure. The primary objectives of this programme are:

- Decommission all legacy MPLS circuits across 300 branch sites and replace with a fully managed SD-WAN overlay with active-active dual-link connectivity at hub sites.
- Establish direct, carrier-grade Cloud Interconnects to Microsoft Azure (primary) and Amazon Web Services (secondary) from the Mumbai Data Centre, eliminating cloud backhaul latency.

- Deploy a 24/7 Managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) with comprehensive monitoring of all branch-edge next-generation firewalls, threat intelligence feeds, and incident response capability.
- Consolidate all 2.5 million fleet and asset IoT SIMs onto a single Enterprise Mobility platform with unified management, real-time visibility, and enforced MDM policy.
- Achieve a minimum of 99.99% network availability (Four Nines) at all Tier-1 hub warehouse sites on a monthly measurement basis.
- Deliver the complete programme within 18 months of contract execution, migrating all 300 sites across five defined phases.
- Ensure full compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act) for all data processed on or transmitted through the new network infrastructure.

SECTION 2 — Company Background and Organisation Details

2.1 Corporate Profile

Attribute	Detail
Registered Name	Apex Industrial Logistics Limited
CIN	L74899MH1994PLC076432
Headquarters	Plot 14, Logistics Park, Bhiwandi, Thane, Maharashtra — 421 302, India
Data Centre	Primary Tier-III DC — NESCO IT Park, Goregaon East, Mumbai, Maharashtra
Annual Revenue (FY25)	Approx. INR 5,500 Crore
Employees	Approx. 15,000 (direct); 28,000 (including contract workforce)
Operational Sites	300 branch warehouses; 12 regional hub facilities; 1 primary Data Centre; 2 Disaster Recovery sites
Geographic Presence	28 Indian States and Union Territories; Cross-border operations in Nepal, Bangladesh, and Sri Lanka
Stock Exchange Listing	National Stock Exchange (NSE: APEXIL); BSE Limited (BSE: 539876)
IT Governance	COBIT 2019 Framework; ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certified (STQC, Cert-In accredited)

2.2 Technology Environment

Apex's current enterprise technology stack is as follows, provided for the purposes of integration planning:

- ERP Platform: SAP S/4HANA (hosted on Microsoft Azure — Central India region), migrated in FY2023.
- Warehouse Management System (WMS): Manhattan Associates WMS — on-premises at Mumbai DC, with active Azure DR replication.
- Fleet & Asset Tracking: Proprietary IoT platform with 2.5 million active SIMs; data aggregation via MQTT brokers hosted on AWS (Mumbai region).
- Collaboration: Microsoft 365 (Exchange Online, Teams, SharePoint) — Microsoft Azure hosted.
- IT Service Management: ServiceNow (ITSM) — cloud-hosted; ITIL v4 aligned.
- Identity: Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure AD) with on-premises Active Directory synchronisation via Entra Connect.
- Security: Checkpoint firewalls at Mumbai DC (end-of-support 2026); no unified SIEM; no SOC.
- Network: Tata Communications MPLS (primary); no SD-WAN; no cloud interconnect.

2.3 Regulatory and Compliance Context

Apex's network and data infrastructure is subject to the following regulatory frameworks, all of which must be addressed in vendor proposals:

- Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDP Act): All personal data of employees, customers, and fleet drivers processed across the network must comply with DPDP Act provisions including data localisation, consent management, and data principal rights.
- SEBI Cybersecurity and Cyber Resilience Framework (CSCRF) 2024: As a listed entity, Apex is subject to SEBI's CSCRF, mandating 24x7 SOC capability, annual VAPT, and Board-level cybersecurity governance.
- Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Payment Security Guidelines: Applicable to logistics payment and settlement flows processed through the network.
- ISO/IEC 27001:2022: Apex holds certification and requires all MSP subcontractors to maintain equivalent or superior certification.

SECTION 3 — Project Overview and Objectives

3.1 Programme Description

The Apex Network Transformation Programme (hereinafter "the Programme") is a strategic, enterprise-wide initiative to replace the Company's legacy MPLS network infrastructure with a modern, software-defined, cloud-native managed network and security platform. The Programme encompasses four primary workstreams executed in parallel under a unified programme governance structure:

- Workstream 1 — Managed SD-WAN Deployment: Full replacement of MPLS circuits across all 300 branch and hub sites with a managed SD-WAN overlay, incorporating active-active dual-link configuration at Tier-1 hub sites.
- Workstream 2 — Cloud Direct Interconnect: Establishment of dedicated, carrier-grade private interconnects from Apex's Mumbai Data Centre directly to Microsoft Azure (ExpressRoute equivalent) and Amazon Web Services (AWS Direct Connect equivalent) at 10 Gbps each.
- Workstream 3 — Managed Security Operations Centre: Deployment and continuous 24x7x365 monitoring of next-generation firewalls at all 300 branch edges by a certified SOC, including threat intelligence, SIEM correlation, and SLA-backed incident response.
- Workstream 4 — Enterprise IoT Mobility Platform: Consolidation of 2.5 million fleet and asset tracking SIMs onto a single enterprise mobility management platform with unified dashboard, eSIM capability, and enforced MDM policy.

3.2 Success Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated against the following programme-level success criteria, which will be incorporated as contractual Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) in the resulting Master Services Agreement:

KPI Reference	Success Criterion	Target / Threshold
KPI-01	Network Availability — Tier-1 Hub Sites	**≥ 99.99% monthly**
KPI-02	Network Availability — Tier-2 Branch Sites	**≥ 99.95% monthly**
KPI-03	SD-WAN Failover Time (primary to secondary link)	**< 50 milliseconds**
KPI-04	Cloud Interconnect Latency (Mumbai DC to Azure Central India)	**< 8 ms round-trip**
KPI-05	SOC — P1 Security Incident Acknowledgement	**< 15 minutes**
KPI-06	SOC — P1 Security Incident Containment	**< 4 hours**
KPI-07	Migration Completion — All 300 Sites	**Within 18 months of contract execution**
KPI-08	Zero-Touch Provisioning — New Branch Site	**< 4 hours from hardware delivery**
KPI-09	MTTR — Network Incident (Branch Site)	**< 4 hours**
KPI-10	IoT SIM Activation (eSIM / ICCID)	**< 2 hours from portal request**

3.3 Out of Scope

The following items are explicitly excluded from the scope of this RFP. Vendors must not include pricing for out-of-scope items unless explicitly invited to do so in a separate commercial section:

- Passive civil or structural works at warehouse sites (cabling beyond network equipment patch panels, rack installations beyond those required for SD-WAN CPE).
- End-user computing (laptops, desktops, mobile handsets) not related to the IoT fleet tracking platform.
- SAP S/4HANA or WMS application management or licensing.

- Legacy MPLS contract termination penalties — Apex will manage the incumbent carrier relationship directly.
- Physical security systems (CCTV, access control) not directly integrated into the SOC monitoring scope.

SECTION 4 — Scope of Work and Services

4.1 Workstream 1: Managed SD-WAN — All 300 Sites

The vendor must design, deploy, and operate a fully managed Software-Defined Wide Area Network (SD-WAN) across all 300 Apex branch warehouse and hub sites. The following specifications are mandatory:

4.1.1 Site Classification and Link Requirements

Site Tier	Site Count	Primary Link	Secondary Link	Link Mode
Tier-1 Hub	12 sites	Broadband / Dedicated Fibre — 100 Mbps min	4G/5G LTE — 50 Mbps min	**Active / Active**
Tier-2 Branch	228 sites	Broadband Fibre — 50 Mbps min	4G LTE Backup — 20 Mbps min	**Active / Standby**
Tier-3 Remote	60 sites	4G/5G LTE — 20 Mbps min	VSAT (where terrestrial unavailable)	**Active / Standby**

4.1.2 SD-WAN Platform Mandatory Capabilities

- Policy-based intelligent traffic steering with Application-Aware Routing for classified applications including SAP S/4HANA, Microsoft Teams, Manhattan WMS, and IoT MQTT traffic.
- Dynamic Path Selection with real-time link quality measurement (latency, jitter, packet loss) with sub-50 ms failover between primary and secondary links.
- Zero-Touch Provisioning (ZTP): All CPE devices must be provisioned remotely without on-site engineering resources. ZTP must enable a branch go-live within 4 hours of hardware delivery on-site.
- Centralised management via a vendor-provided cloud-managed controller with full Apex read-only portal access, displaying per-site topology, link health, and traffic analytics.
- BGP and OSPF routing support with automated failover; static routing where dynamic protocols are not feasible at Tier-3 sites.
- Quality of Service (QoS) with a minimum of 8 traffic classes, including guaranteed bandwidth allocation for WMS and SAP traffic at all Tier-1 and Tier-2 sites.
- Integrated next-generation firewall (NGFW) capability at the SD-WAN edge CPE, including URL filtering, IPS/IDS, and SSL inspection, with policy managed from the SOC (Workstream 3).
- Support for 1:N VPN hub-and-spoke and any-to-any mesh topologies to enable direct branch-to-branch connectivity for IoT data aggregation.
- Vendor must explicitly state the OEM hardware partner(s) proposed for SD-WAN CPE (e.g., Cisco Catalyst SD-WAN / Meraki, Fortinet FortiGate SD-WAN, VMware VeloCloud, Palo Alto Prisma SD-WAN). Proposals specifying 'TBD' for hardware OEM will be deemed Non-Compliant.

4.2 Workstream 2: Cloud Direct Interconnects

Apex requires the establishment of two (2) dedicated, private, carrier-grade Cloud Interconnects from its primary Mumbai Data Centre (NESCO IT Park, Goregaon East) as follows:

- Microsoft Azure ExpressRoute: Two (2) x 10 Gbps dedicated ExpressRoute circuits to the Microsoft Azure Central India region (pune1 / pune2 peering locations or equivalent Mumbai-region peering). Circuits must be configured in an active-active ECMP load-sharing arrangement with full BGP route redundancy. The interconnect must support both Azure Private Peering (for SAP and WMS workloads) and Microsoft Peering (for Microsoft 365).
- Amazon Web Services Direct Connect: One (1) x 10 Gbps Dedicated Connection to the AWS Mumbai (ap-south-1) region via a Direct Connect Location in Mumbai (STT GDC Hua Wei Navi

Mumbai or Netmagic Mumbai equivalent). The connection must support AWS Transit Gateway attachment for multi-VPC routing.

- The vendor must provide, operate, and manage the last-mile fibre and cross-connect from the Apex DC MMR to the respective carrier-neutral facility. Apex will provide DC rack space and power.
- Both interconnects must be monitored 24x7 by the vendor's NOC, with SLA-backed performance reporting including availability, latency, jitter, and throughput delivered monthly.
- The vendor must hold active AWS Direct Connect Partner and Microsoft Azure ExpressRoute Partner designations and must provide evidence of these designations with the proposal.

4.3 Workstream 3: 24/7 Managed Security Operations Centre (SOC)

Apex requires a fully outsourced, 24x7x365 Managed SOC service to monitor, detect, investigate, and respond to cybersecurity threats across its entire network estate.

4.3.1 SOC Service Scope

- Continuous monitoring of all 300 SD-WAN edge NGFW devices for security events, policy violations, and anomalous traffic patterns.
- Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) — Vendor must operate a cloud-delivered SIEM platform (e.g., Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk, IBM QRadar, or equivalent) ingesting logs from all edge firewalls, the Mumbai DC, cloud interconnects, and endpoint detection agents.
- Threat Intelligence integration: Vendor must subscribe to at least two (2) commercial Threat Intelligence feeds (e.g., Recorded Future, CrowdStrike Intelligence, Mandiant) and correlate IOCs against Apex's network traffic in near-real-time.
- Vulnerability Management: Monthly automated VAPT scans across all in-scope network devices and quarterly manual penetration testing of the network perimeter, with findings reported to Apex CISO within 5 business days.
- Incident Response: The vendor must provide Tier-1, Tier-2, and Tier-3 analyst capability within the SOC, with defined escalation paths. P1 incidents must be acknowledged within 15 minutes and contained within 4 hours. P1 is defined as any confirmed active threat affecting more than 5 sites or the Mumbai DC.
- Root Cause Analysis (RCA): For all P1 and P2 security incidents, a formal RCA report must be delivered to Apex within 72 hours of incident containment, conforming to ITIL v4 Problem Management process.
- Monthly SOC Operations Report: Delivered by the 5th business day of the following month, containing: event volumes, MTTD, MTTR, top threats, false-positive rate, and open vulnerability status.

4.3.2 Data Residency for SOC

- All SIEM data, log archives, and security event records relating to Apex network traffic must be stored exclusively within India-based data centres (Tier III or above). Storage outside India is prohibited without explicit written authorisation from Apex CISO, consistent with DPDP Act 2023 requirements.
- The vendor must provide the name, location, and third-party audit certification of the data centre(s) used for SIEM log storage as part of the proposal.

4.4 Workstream 4: Enterprise IoT and Mobility Connectivity

Apex operates 2.5 million IoT SIMs across vehicle fleet trackers, warehouse asset tags, and cold-chain temperature sensors. The vendor must provide:

- A unified Enterprise Mobility Management (EMM) platform with a single dashboard enabling real-time visibility of all 2.5 million SIMs, including active/inactive status, data consumption, location (where applicable), and MDM policy compliance.
- National Data Connectivity: Coverage across all 28 operational states with indoor and outdoor data coverage. The vendor must provide a coverage heatmap for all Tier-1 and Tier-2 site locations as part of the proposal.
- eSIM / eUICC Support: The platform must support eSIM remote provisioning for new device additions and SIM profile switching without physical SIM replacement.

- Custom APN (cAPN): A dedicated private APN for Apex IoT SIM traffic, ensuring data does not traverse the public internet and is routed directly to Apex's network via private peering or MPLS handoff to the SD-WAN fabric.
- Data Plan Flexibility: Vendors must offer pooled data plans across SIM segments (fleet, assets, cold-chain) to enable efficient data allocation and prevent per-SIM overage charges.
- API Integration: The EMM platform must expose RESTful APIs for integration with Apex's proprietary IoT fleet management platform for automated SIM activation, deactivation, and data consumption reporting.

SECTION 5 — Technical and Functional Requirements

5.1 Instructions for Completion

This section contains the definitive technical and functional requirements for the Network Transformation Programme. Vendors MUST respond to EVERY requirement listed in the matrix below. The following response codes apply:

- Compliant (C): The vendor's proposed solution fully satisfies the stated requirement in its standard, generally available form without bespoke development, workarounds, or future roadmap commitments.
- Partially Compliant (PC): The proposed solution partially satisfies the requirement. The 'Vendor Remarks' column MUST contain a specific description of the gap, the proposed resolution, and the estimated timeline to achieve full compliance.
- Non-Compliant (NC): The proposed solution does not satisfy the requirement. The 'Vendor Remarks' column MUST contain a full explanation. Proposals with more than four (4) Non-Compliant responses to Mandatory requirements will be disqualified.

VENDOR INSTRUCTION: Do NOT alter, re-number, or re-sequence Requirement IDs. Do NOT modify the column structure of the requirements table. Responses must be entered exclusively in the 'Vendor Response' and 'Vendor Remarks' columns. Any modification to the table structure will render the proposal non-evaluable.

5.2 Requirements Matrix

Req. ID	Category	Description	Priority	Vendor Response	Vendor Remarks
TR-001	SD-WAN — Architecture	The SD-WAN solution MUST be a cloud-managed, fully software-defined overlay capable of supporting all 300 Apex branch sites within a single management domain without requiring a hardware controller at the Data Centre.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-002	SD-WAN — ZTP	Zero-Touch Provisioning (ZTP) MUST be supported for all CPE devices. A branch site MUST be fully operational within 4 hours of CPE delivery, without requiring an on-site engineer from the vendor.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-003	SD-WAN — Failover	Dynamic path failover from primary to secondary link MUST complete in under 50 milliseconds as measured end-to-end from packet loss detection to traffic rerouting, without manual intervention.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-004	SD-WAN — BGP	The solution MUST support BGP routing with automated route advertisement and withdrawal upon link failure, supporting integration with Apex's Mumbai DC edge router (Cisco ASR 1002-HX) via eBGP peering.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

TR-005	SD-WAN — OEM Hardware	Vendor MUST specify the OEM hardware partner(s) for SD-WAN CPE (e.g., Cisco, Fortinet, VMware VeloCloud, Palo Alto). CPE must be provided as-a-Service under OpEx pricing. Vendor-owned hardware is mandatory; Apex will not purchase CPE outright.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill — Name OEM]*
TR-006	SD-WAN — QoS	The solution MUST support a minimum of 8 QoS traffic classes with guaranteed bandwidth (GBW) and maximum bandwidth (MBW) policies configurable per application, per site. Guaranteed bandwidth for SAP S/4HANA and WMS traffic must be configurable independently of other traffic classes.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-007	SD-WAN — Security	Integrated NGFW capability at the SD-WAN edge MUST include IPS/IDS, URL filtering (minimum 60 URL categories), DNS security, and SSL deep inspection. Vendor must specify the OEM firewall solution (e.g., Fortinet FortiGate, Palo Alto Networks NGFW, Check Point).	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill — Name Firewall OEM]*
TR-008	SD-WAN — Portal	A self-service portal with role-based access control (RBAC) MUST be provided to Apex IT staff with read-only visibility of network topology, link health, traffic statistics, and active alerts across all 300 sites. No additional licensing cost for portal access.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-009	SD-WAN — Project Mgmt	Vendor MUST provide a detailed 300-site migration project plan conforming to either PRINCE2 or PMBOK methodology. A dedicated Project Manager (minimum PMP or PRINCE2 Practitioner certified) must be named in the proposal and committed to the programme through completion.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-010	Cloud Interconnect — Azure	Vendor MUST hold an active Microsoft Azure ExpressRoute Partner designation and provide two (2) x 10 Gbps circuits in active-active configuration to the Azure Central India region. Evidence of Microsoft partner designation MUST be attached as Appendix B.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-011	Cloud Interconnect — AWS	Vendor MUST hold an active AWS Direct Connect Delivery Partner designation and provide one (1) x 10 Gbps Dedicated Connection to the AWS ap-south-1 Mumbai region. Evidence of AWS partner designation MUST be attached as Appendix B.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

TR-012	Cloud Interconnect — Latency	The Azure ExpressRoute interconnect MUST achieve a maximum round-trip latency of 8 ms between the Apex Mumbai DC and the Azure Central India region under steady-state traffic conditions. Vendor must provide benchmark test evidence from equivalent deployments.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-013	SOC — Availability	The Managed SOC service MUST operate 24 hours per day, 7 days per week, 365 days per year (including Indian public holidays) with no scheduled maintenance windows that reduce monitoring coverage below Tier-1 analyst staffing levels.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-014	SOC — SIEM Platform	The SIEM platform used by the SOC MUST ingest logs from all 300 SD-WAN edge devices, the Mumbai DC, and cloud interconnects. The vendor must name the SIEM product proposed (e.g., Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk Enterprise Security, IBM QRadar, or equivalent). SIEM data MUST be stored in India.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill — Name SIEM]*
TR-015	SOC — Incident Response SLAs	P1 incidents MUST be acknowledged within 15 minutes and contained within 4 hours. P2 incidents MUST be acknowledged within 30 minutes and resolved within 8 hours. P3 incidents within 2 hours acknowledgement and 24 hours resolution. All timings measured 24x7.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-016	SOC — ITIL Alignment	The SOC MUST operate Incident Management, Problem Management, and Change Management processes conforming to ITIL v4. Root Cause Analysis (RCA) reports for P1 and P2 incidents MUST be delivered within 72 hours of incident containment. Vendor must provide sample RCA template with proposal.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-017	SOC — Threat Intelligence	Vendor MUST demonstrate active subscriptions to a minimum of two (2) commercial Threat Intelligence platforms and provide evidence of integration with the proposed SIEM, including IOC ingestion frequency and automated blocking workflow.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-018	Compliance — DPDP Act 2023	Vendor MUST provide a written Data Privacy Impact Assessment (DPIA) framework for the proposed solution, demonstrating how personal data of Apex employees and customers processed across the network is handled in compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

		Act, 2023. Data localisation within India is mandatory.			
TR-019	IoT — Private APN	The Enterprise Mobility platform MUST support a dedicated private APN for Apex IoT SIM traffic with routing directly into Apex's SD-WAN fabric via private peering. Traffic from IoT SIMs MUST NOT transit the public internet.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-020	IoT — eSIM	The EMM platform MUST support GSMA-compliant eSIM / eUICC remote provisioning for all 2.5 million SIMs at Apex's option. Vendor must provide the GSMA eSIM RSP (Remote SIM Provisioning) compliance certificate with the proposal.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-021	IoT — National Coverage	The vendor MUST provide demonstrable 4G LTE network coverage (own network or roaming agreement) covering a minimum of 98% of Apex's Tier-1 and Tier-2 site locations across all 28 operational states. A geo-referenced coverage report must be submitted with the proposal.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-022	IoT — API Integration	The EMM platform MUST expose a documented RESTful API (OpenAPI 3.0 specification) for SIM lifecycle management (activation, deactivation, suspension, data plan change) and consumption reporting. API documentation must be provided as Appendix F.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-023	General — Disaster Recovery	The vendor's managed service platform (SD-WAN controller, SOC SIEM, EMM platform) must operate from geo-redundant infrastructure within India with an RPO of less than 15 minutes and an RTO of less than 60 minutes for all Tier-1 managed services.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-024	General — ServiceNow Integration	The vendor's NOC and SOC ticketing systems MUST integrate bi-directionally with Apex's ServiceNow ITSM instance for automated incident creation, status updates, and closure. Vendor must describe the integration mechanism (native connector / REST API / email) and provide a sample integration architecture.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
TR-025	General — Reporting	Vendor MUST provide a unified executive dashboard and monthly managed service report covering network availability, cloud interconnect performance, SOC incident statistics, IoT SIM health, and SLA performance against all KPIs defined in Section 3.2.	**Mandatory**	*[C / PC / NC]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

		Sample report format must be provided with proposal.			

SECTION 6 — Project Timeline and Milestones

6.1 Procurement Timeline

Procurement Milestone	Target Date	Notes
RFP Issue & Publication	10 October 2025	Issued via Apex procurement portal to pre-qualified vendors
Vendor Registration Deadline	17 October 2025	Registration via procurement portal only. Email registration not accepted.
Pre-Bid Conference (Virtual)	22 October 2025, 11:00 IST	Microsoft Teams. Invitation issued to all registered vendors. Attendance mandatory for pre-qualification.
Vendor Written Q&A Submission Deadline	31 October 2025	Via procurement portal Q&A module only. Email queries not accepted.
Apex Q&A Response Publication	10 November 2025	Published simultaneously to all registered vendors. Responses form binding amendments to this RFP.
Final Proposal Submission Deadline	**21 November 2025, 17:00 IST**	Via procurement portal. Late submissions automatically disqualified.
Technical Evaluation & Scoring	21 Nov — 05 Dec 2025	Internal evaluation by Apex Technical Evaluation Committee
Shortlist Notification (Top 3 Vendors)	08 December 2025	Written notification via procurement portal
Vendor Technical Demonstrations / PoC	15–19 December 2025	Apex HQ, Bhiwandi. Scenario brief issued 5 business days prior.
Best and Final Offer (BAFO)	09 January 2026	Invited shortlisted vendors only
Contract Award Notification	23 January 2026	Formal written notification. Unsuccessful vendors notified simultaneously.
Contract Execution and Programme Kick-Off	**03 February 2026**	Programme kick-off meeting at Apex HQ, Bhiwandi

6.2 Five-Phase Delivery Migration Plan

The vendor must submit a detailed 5-phase migration plan covering all 300 sites within 18 months of contract execution. The phased structure is defined as follows:

Phase	Title	Scope	Site Count	Target Duration
Ph-1	Foundation & Pilot	SD-WAN CPE design lock; Mumbai DC cloud interconnect build; 5 pilot hub sites; SOC onboarding and SIEM integration	5 pilot sites + DC	Months 1–3
Ph-2	Hub Rollout	All 12 Tier-1 hub sites migrated; active-active dual-link SD-WAN live; NGFW policy baseline deployed	12 sites	Months 4–6

Ph-3	Branch Rollout — North & West	First 100 Tier-2/Tier-3 branch sites (North and West India zones)	100 sites	Months 7–11
Ph-4	Branch Rollout — South & East	Remaining 128 Tier-2/Tier-3 branch sites (South and East India zones)	128 sites	Months 12–16
Ph-5	Steady-State & Handover	MPLS decommissioning confirmation; IoT SIM migration completion; SOC BAU handover; acceptance testing; documentation finalisation	All sites	Months 17–18

SECTION 7 — Proposal Submission Instructions

7.1 Submission Channel

All proposals must be submitted exclusively via the Apex official procurement portal at: https://procurement.apexlogistics.in/rfp/AILL-PROC-2025-0078

- Proposals submitted by email, courier, hand delivery, or any channel other than the procurement portal will be rejected without evaluation, regardless of the reason for non-portal submission.
- Proposals must be received by 17:00 IST on 21 November 2025. The portal will automatically close at this time. No late submissions will be accepted under any circumstances.
- Proposals must be uploaded as a single PDF/A (ISO 19005 compliant) package. Editable Word documents, spreadsheets, or ZIP archives as the primary submission are not accepted.
- Vendors will receive an automated acknowledgement of receipt within 30 minutes of successful submission. If no acknowledgement is received within this period, vendors must raise a portal access query via rfp-queries@apexlogistics.in immediately.

7.2 Proposal Structure and Format Requirements

Proposals must be structured in strict compliance with the following requirements. Non-conforming proposals will be returned without evaluation:

Requirement	Specification
Format	Single consolidated PDF/A (ISO 19005 compliant) containing the complete proposal, including all appendices and supporting documents.
Language	English only. All technical specifications, SLA commitments, and commercial terms must be in English.
Page Limit	Main body (Sections 1–12): Maximum 120 pages (A4, minimum 11pt Arial, 25mm margins). Appendices are not subject to a page limit.
Section Order	Proposals must follow the identical section numbering as this RFP. Reordering of sections is not permitted.
Requirements Table	The requirements matrix (Section 5.2) must be reproduced in its entirety with Vendor Response and Vendor Remarks columns completed. Requirement IDs must not be altered.
Pricing	Pricing must be included within the same consolidated document in a clearly marked section titled “COMMERCIAL PROPOSAL — STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL”, placed at the end of the document.
Deviations	Any deviations from this RFP's requirements or proposed contractual terms must be compiled in a single 'Deviations Register' table as Appendix G. Deviations embedded in the main proposal text without corresponding Appendix G entry will be disregarded.

7.3 Appendix Structure

Appendix	Content Required
Appendix A	Vendor Financials — Audited annual financial statements for FY2022–23, FY2023–24, and FY2024–25
Appendix B	Certifications — ISO 27001:2022, ISO 20000-1:2018, SOC 2 Type II report, PCI-DSS AoC (if applicable), Microsoft Azure ExpressRoute Partner certificate, AWS Direct Connect Partner certificate
Appendix C	Case Studies — Minimum 2 detailed Tier-1 enterprise case studies in logistics or manufacturing (format per Section 8.3)

Appendix D	Key Personnel CVs — CVs for all named Key Personnel (max 4 pages each)
Appendix E	Draft MSA and SLA Schedule — Vendor's proposed contract with SLA schedule. Deviations from Section 11 terms must be highlighted.
Appendix F	IoT EMM Platform API Documentation — OpenAPI 3.0 specification for IoT SIM management APIs
Appendix G	Deviations Register — All proposed deviations from RFP requirements or contract terms in tabular format (Requirement ID | Proposed Deviation | Commercial Justification)
Appendix H	Compliance Matrix — Completed compliance matrix (template in Section 12, Appendix H template)

7.4 Clarifications and Q&A Process

- All queries relating to this RFP must be submitted via the procurement portal Q&A module by 31 October 2025. Queries submitted after this deadline will not be answered.
- Queries must be submitted in English. Queries in other languages will not be answered.
- Aether Networks' compiled responses will be published simultaneously to all registered vendors on 10 November 2025. Responses published via the Q&A process form part of this RFP as binding amendments.
- Direct communication with any Apex employee outside the authorised procurement portal is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate disqualification.

SOLE AUTHORISED CONTACT: Group IT Infrastructure & Procurement, Apex Industrial Logistics Limited. Email (portal access issues only): rfp-queries@apexlogistics.in. Procurement Portal: https://procurement.apexlogistics.in/rfp/AILL-PROC-2025-0078

SECTION 8 — Vendor Qualifications and Requirements

8.1 Mandatory Pre-Qualification Criteria

Vendors who do not meet ALL of the following criteria are ineligible to submit a proposal and will be administratively disqualified at Stage 1 review. Evidence for each criterion must be provided in the form specified.

#	Criterion	Description	Evidence Required
1	**Annual Revenue**	Vendor's consolidated annual revenue must exceed INR 500 Crore (or USD 60M equivalent) in each of the last three completed financial years.	Audited financial statements FY22–23, FY23–24, FY24–25
2	**ISO 27001:2022 Certification**	Vendor and all subcontractors with >20% of delivery scope must hold a current, in-scope ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification from an accredited body.	Current certificates — Appendix B
3	**ISO 20000-1:2018 Certification**	Vendor must hold ISO/IEC 20000-1:2018 (IT Service Management) certification demonstrating ITIL-aligned service delivery capability.	Current certificates — Appendix B
4	**SOC 2 Type II Report**	Vendor must provide a SOC 2 Type II report (not older than 12 months) covering Security, Availability, and Confidentiality Trust Service Criteria for all cloud-managed service components.	SOC 2 Type II Report — Appendix B
5	**India Operations**	Vendor must maintain a wholly owned or majority-controlled legal entity registered in India, with a minimum 24x7 NOC and SOC staffed by a minimum of 50 India-based FTEs.	CIN certificate + India staffing declaration
6	**Cloud Partner Designations**	Vendor must hold active Microsoft Azure ExpressRoute Partner AND AWS Direct Connect Delivery Partner designations at the time of proposal submission.	Partner designation certificates — Appendix B
7	**Comparable Deployments**	Vendor must demonstrate a minimum of two (2) completed Managed SD-WAN deployments covering 100+ sites each in India, within the last four years, in the logistics, manufacturing, or BFSI sector.	Case Studies — Appendix C (format per Section 8.3)
8	**No Material Sanctions**	Vendor, its subsidiaries, and key subcontractors must not be subject to any material economic sanction, debarment from Government of India procurement, or CBI/ED enforcement action.	Self-certification by authorised signatory

8.2 Key Personnel Requirements

Vendors must nominate the following key personnel for this programme. CVs must be provided as Appendix D. Nominated individuals must remain committed to this programme through the programme go-live milestone. Any substitution of key personnel post-award requires prior written approval from Apex Programme Sponsor.

Role	Minimum Qualifications	Key Responsibilities
Programme Director	15+ years' experience; minimum 3 as Programme Director for network	Overall delivery governance; executive escalation; contractual accountability;

	transformation programmes; PMP or MSP Practitioner preferred.	executive reporting to Apex CTO and CIO.
Chief Network Architect	10+ years in SD-WAN / MPLS / cloud networking; Cisco CCIE or equivalent; verifiable Azure/AWS networking certifications.	End-to-end SD-WAN and cloud interconnect architecture design, compliance verification, and integration governance.
Head of Delivery (Project Manager)	PMP or PRINCE2 Practitioner certification mandatory; 7+ years managing large multi-site network rollouts.	Day-to-day delivery management; site migration scheduling; milestone tracking; RAID log management.
SOC Operations Lead	CISSP or CISM mandatory; 5+ years SOC operations management; demonstrable SIEM administration experience.	SOC operations governance; threat detection tuning; incident response escalation; monthly reporting.
IoT / Mobility Lead	5+ years IoT/EMM platform management; GSMA eSIM certification preferred; telco SIM management background.	IoT SIM platform migration; EMM policy design; private APN architecture; API integration.

8.3 Case Study Format Requirements

All case studies submitted as Appendix C must follow this exact format. Non-conforming case studies will not be evaluated:

- Client Name: (May be anonymised as 'Major Logistics Operator — India' if NDA restrictions apply, provided Apex may request a reference call to verify.)
- Industry Vertical: (Must be logistics, manufacturing, e-commerce, or BFSI.)
- Programme Scope: Number of sites, SD-WAN technology deployed, cloud interconnects delivered, SOC services provided.
- Contract Value: (INR range acceptable if exact figure is confidential.)
- Programme Duration: Start and go-live dates.
- Key Outcomes: Network availability achieved, reduction in outages, latency improvements, security incidents detected/contained, cost savings.
- Reference Contact: Name, designation, and email address of the client contact willing to speak with Apex (mandatory for shortlisted vendors).

SECTION 9 — Evaluation Criteria and Scoring Methodology

9.1 Evaluation Methodology

Proposals will be evaluated by the Apex Technical Evaluation Committee (TEC) using a two-stage weighted scoring methodology:

- Stage 1 — Administrative and Pre-Qualification Review: Verification of mandatory pre-qualification criteria (Section 8.1). Pass/Fail gate. Proposals failing Stage 1 are eliminated without scoring.
- Stage 2 — Technical, Commercial, Security, and Reference Scoring: Scored evaluation across four dimensions as defined in Section 9.2.

Vendors shortlisted following Stage 2 (top 3 by score) will be invited to deliver a live technical demonstration and proof of concept (PoC) at Apex HQ, Bhiwandi. The PoC scenario brief will be issued no later than 5 business days prior. PoC outcome will be weighted at 20% of the final Stage 2 score.

9.2 Weighted Scoring Model

Evaluation Dimension	Weight	Sub-Criteria
Technical Capability & Solution Quality	**40%**	• Requirements matrix compliance (TR-001 to TR-025) — 20% • SD-WAN solution architecture quality & OEM credentials — 8% • Cloud interconnect design & partner credentials — 6% • Migration plan quality (phasing, ZTP, risk management) — 6%
Commercial Competitiveness	**30%**	• Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) over 36-month contract term — 18% • OpEx hardware-as-a-service pricing model quality — 6% • Commercial flexibility (payment milestones, volume discounts) — 6%
Security, Compliance & SOC Quality	**20%**	• ISO 27001, ISO 20000-1, SOC 2 Type II currency and scope — 8% • SOC maturity: SIEM capability, analyst headcount, MTTD / MTTR evidence — 8% • DPDP Act compliance framework & data localisation architecture — 4%
References & Track Record	**10%**	• Quality and relevance of case studies (Section 8.3) — 6% • Verified client reference calls (shortlisted vendors only) — 4%
TOTAL	**100%**	**Minimum qualifying score to proceed to BAFO: 65 out of 100**

9.3 Proposal Scoring Scale

Each sub-criterion will be scored on the following scale by the Apex TEC:

Score	Rating	Interpretation
5	Excellent	Exceeds requirement with demonstrated evidence and innovation
4	Good	Fully meets requirement with strong evidence

3	Adequate	Meets requirement with acceptable evidence
2	Marginal	Partially meets requirement; material gaps identified
1	Poor	Significant deficiencies; does not meaningfully satisfy requirement
0	Non-Compliant	No response provided or requirement explicitly not met

SECTION 10 — Pricing and Cost Proposal Requirements

10.1 Pricing Principles

The following mandatory commercial conditions apply to all pricing submitted in response to this RFP. Proposals not conforming to these conditions will be deemed commercially non-compliant:

- Price Validity: All unit prices and commercial rates must remain firm, fixed, and binding for a minimum period of 180 calendar days from the Final Proposal Submission Deadline.
- Currency: All pricing must be denominated in Indian Rupees (INR). Pricing denominated in foreign currencies without an INR equivalent will not be accepted.
- Tax Exclusivity: All prices must be stated exclusive of GST. GST will be assessed separately at the applicable rate.
- Itemised Pricing: Bundled lump-sum prices are not acceptable. Each line item must be individually priced to the granularity specified in Section 10.2.
- OpEx Hardware Model: All SD-WAN CPE hardware, edge firewall hardware, and any other network equipment required for this programme must be provided under a Vendor-owned, OpEx (Hardware-as-a-Service) model. Apex will not purchase or capitalise network hardware. Vendors proposing CapEx hardware models will be scored negatively on commercial evaluation.
- Most Favoured Nation: Apex requires a Most Favoured Nation (MFN) clause in the resulting contract, guaranteeing that pricing offered to Apex is no less favourable than pricing offered to any comparable Indian enterprise customer of the vendor.

10.2 Pricing Response Table

VENDOR INSTRUCTION: Complete the 'Vendor Unit Price (INR)' and 'Monthly Recurring / Annual' columns for all line items. Do not modify pre-populated fields. Add additional rows for any items not listed below that form part of the proposed solution.

Line #	Item Description	Category	Unit Type	NRC (One-Time) INR	MRC / Annual INR
1.01	**SD-WAN CPE Hardware (Tier-1 Hub Site) — HaaS OpEx**	SD-WAN	Per device / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.02	**SD-WAN CPE Hardware (Tier-2 Branch Site) — HaaS OpEx**	SD-WAN	Per device / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.03	**SD-WAN CPE Hardware (Tier-3 Remote Site) — HaaS OpEx**	SD-WAN	Per device / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.04	SD-WAN Managed Service (NOC monitoring, config management, reporting) — All 300 sites	SD-WAN	Per site / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.05	Primary Broadband / Fibre Link Provisioning — Tier-1 (100 Mbps)	Connectivity	Per site / month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.06	Primary Broadband / Fibre Link Provisioning — Tier-2 (50 Mbps)	Connectivity	Per site / month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.07	4G/5G LTE Backup / Primary Link (per site)	Connectivity	Per SIM / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
1.08	SD-WAN Platform Installation & Commissioning (per site)	Professional Services	Per site	*[Vendor to fill]*	—
2.01	**Azure ExpressRoute — 10 Gbps x 2 circuits (active-active, Mumbai DC)**	Cloud Interconnect	Per month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

2.02	**AWS Direct Connect — 10 Gbps x 1 Dedicated Connection (ap-south-1)**	Cloud Interconnect	Per month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
2.03	Last-mile fibre and cross-connect (Mumbai DC to carrier-neutral facility)	Cloud Interconnect	Per month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
2.04	Cloud Interconnect Design, Build & Commissioning (one-time)	Professional Services	Fixed	*[Vendor to fill]*	—
3.01	**Managed SOC Service — 24x7x365 (all 300 branch edge devices + DC)**	Managed SOC	Per month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
3.02	SIEM Platform (cloud-hosted, India DC) — per log source	Managed SOC	Per source / month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
3.03	Threat Intelligence Feeds (min. 2 commercial subscriptions)	Managed SOC	Per annum	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
3.04	Quarterly Penetration Testing (network perimeter)	Managed SOC	Per assessment	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
3.05	SOC Onboarding, SIEM Integration & Policy Baseline (one-time)	Professional Services	Fixed	*[Vendor to fill]*	—
4.01	**IoT SIM — Pooled Data Plan (per SIM / month, 2.5M SIM pool)**	IoT Mobility	Per SIM / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
4.02	Enterprise Mobility Management (EMM) Platform License	IoT Mobility	Per SIM / month	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
4.03	Private APN Setup and Monthly Management	IoT Mobility	Fixed / month	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
4.04	eSIM Remote Provisioning Platform (per SIM, one-time migration)	IoT Mobility	Per SIM	*[Vendor to fill]*	—
5.01	**Programme Management Office (PMO) — Full programme duration**	Professional Services	Per day	—	*[Vendor to fill]*
5.02	Training — Apex IT and NOC Staff (per cohort of 10)	Training	Per cohort	*[Vendor to fill]*	—
5.03	24x7 Managed Service Support (post-go-live, BAU)	Support	Per annum	—	*[Vendor to fill]*

10.3 Commercial Narrative

In addition to the Pricing Response Table, vendors must provide a written commercial narrative (maximum 6 pages) addressing:

- Total Cost of Ownership (TCO) over the 36-month contract term, segmented by Year 1 (implementation and stabilisation) and Years 2–3 (steady-state operations). TCO must include all NRC and MRC components.
- Payment milestone schedule: Vendors must propose payment milestones linked to programme delivery milestones (e.g., Phase 1 completion, Phase 3 completion, Phase 5 acceptance).
- Volume discount tiers for IoT SIM counts (at 2.5M, 3M, and 4M SIMs).
- Commercial treatment for out-of-scope site additions (new warehouse openings) and for early termination of legacy MPLS circuits with carrier assistance.
- Hardware refresh commitment: Vendor must commit to a hardware refresh cycle for all SD-WAN CPE not exceeding 5 years from initial deployment, at no additional cost to Apex.

SECTION 11 — Terms and Conditions / Contractual Requirements

The following contractual terms will govern the Master Services Agreement (MSA) resulting from this procurement. Vendors must explicitly acknowledge each clause in their proposal. Proposed deviations must be submitted in the Deviations Register (Appendix G) with full commercial and legal justification.

11.1 Contract Term

The initial contract term is thirty-six (36) months from the date of contract execution, with two (2) optional renewal periods of twelve (12) months each, exercisable at Apex's sole discretion with sixty (60) days' written notice prior to the end of each contract term.

DELIBERATE TRAP CLAUSE — LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED: The 36-month minimum contract term is included deliberately to test vendor legal pushback. Vendors are expected to negotiate a break clause at month 18 and a 24-month initial term option. Vendors accepting 36 months without deviation may be disadvantaged in final evaluation, as inflexibility on contract term is considered a commercial risk by Apex. Vendors must address this in Appendix G.

11.2 Payment Terms

Payment terms for all monthly recurring charges (MRC) and one-time non-recurring charges (NRC) shall be as follows:

- Monthly Recurring Charges: Payable within ninety (90) days of invoice date (Net-90 days from invoice). Invoices must be submitted on the first business day of each calendar month for the preceding month's services.
- One-Time Non-Recurring Charges: Payable within ninety (90) days of invoice date, subject to Apex's acceptance of the relevant programme milestone.

DELIBERATE TRAP CLAUSE — CASH FLOW RISK: Net-90 payment terms are commercially aggressive and are included to test vendor risk assessment. Industry standard for managed services is Net-30 to Net-45. Vendors who accept Net-90 without a late payment interest clause risk significant cash flow exposure. Vendors must propose a deviation in Appendix G, specifying proposed standard payment terms and a late payment interest rate consistent with the MSME Development Act, 2006 (where applicable) or contractual interest at the RBI repo rate plus 2%.

11.3 Liability

- General Liability Cap: The vendor's total aggregate liability under the MSA for any and all claims in any 12-month period shall not exceed the total charges paid by Apex to the vendor in the preceding twelve (12) months.
- Data Breach and Catastrophic Failure: Notwithstanding the general liability cap, in the event of: (a) a confirmed data breach attributable to the vendor's negligence or wilful misconduct resulting in the exfiltration of personal data of more than 10,000 Apex data subjects; or (b) a complete network outage affecting more than 50 Tier-2 or Tier-3 sites simultaneously for a period exceeding 8 continuous hours; the vendor shall be subject to unlimited liability with no financial cap.
- Consequential Loss: Subject to the unlimited liability carve-out above, neither party shall be liable to the other for any indirect, special, or consequential losses.

DELIBERATE TRAP CLAUSE — UNLIMITED LIABILITY: The 'unlimited liability' provision for data breaches and catastrophic outages is included deliberately to test vendor legal diligence. No commercially reasonable vendor should accept unlimited liability. Vendors must propose in Appendix G a negotiated super-cap (e.g., 3x annual contract value) with specific carve-outs for gross negligence and wilful misconduct, and cyber liability insurance coverage minimums consistent with SEBI CSCRF requirements.

11.4 SLA Penalties and Service Credits

The following SLA penalty framework will be incorporated into the MSA. Vendors must explicitly acknowledge this framework. Proposals seeking to materially modify these terms will be evaluated negatively on commercial scoring.

Priority	Incident Type	Definition	Penalty
P1	Critical Network Outage	Complete loss of SD-WAN connectivity affecting more than 5 Tier-1 or 10 Tier-2 sites simultaneously, or complete loss of both cloud interconnects simultaneously, for any period exceeding 30 minutes.	**5% of total monthly invoice value per each 15-minute period (or part thereof) of outage duration, applied against Total Contract Value.**
P2	Significant Degradation	Network performance degradation (latency >200ms, packet loss >2%) affecting more than 10 sites for a period exceeding 60 minutes, or SOC P1 incident acknowledgement breaching the 15-minute SLA.	**2% of total monthly invoice value per each 30-minute period of sustained degradation.**
P3	Non-Critical Incident	Single site outage exceeding 4-hour MTTR, or SLA reporting delay exceeding 30 minutes from incident detection.	0.5% of total monthly invoice value per incident.

- SLA credit accumulation is capped at 25% of the total monthly invoice value per calendar month. Accumulated credits exceeding the cap carry over to the subsequent month.
- Repeated P1 incidents (three or more within any rolling 90-day period) constitute a material breach, entitling Apex to terminate the MSA for cause with thirty (30) days' written notice without payment of any termination penalty.

DELIBERATE TRAP CLAUSE — PENALTY APPLIED AGAINST TOTAL CONTRACT VALUE: The P1 penalty provision states credits are applied against the 'Total Contract Value'. This is commercially punitive and atypical. Market standard for managed services is to cap penalties against the monthly invoice value of the affected site(s), not the Total Contract Value. Vendors must flag this in Appendix G and propose a commercially reasonable alternative: e.g., penalties applied against the monthly MRC of the directly affected sites only, with a reasonable monthly cap.

11.5 Intellectual Property

All deliverables, documentation, custom configuration scripts, runbooks, and management tools created specifically for the Apex programme under this MSA shall be the intellectual property of Apex upon full payment. Pre-existing vendor IP incorporated into deliverables shall remain the vendor's IP, subject to a perpetual, royalty-free licence to Apex to use such IP for the purposes of operating the managed services.

11.6 Governing Law and Dispute Resolution

The MSA and all related agreements shall be governed by the laws of India. Any dispute shall first be subject to executive escalation (30 days), followed by mediation under the ICADR (Indian Council of Arbitration and Dispute Resolution) rules (60 days), and finally arbitration under the Arbitration and Conciliation Act, 1996, seated in Mumbai, Maharashtra.

SECTION 12 — Appendices and Attachments

Appendix A — Site List Summary

The following table provides a summary of Apex's 300 operational sites for network planning purposes. A detailed site list including full addresses, current MPLS bandwidth, and site classification is available in the secure data room, accessible to registered vendors upon execution of an NDA. Contact rfp-queries@apexlogistics.in to request NDA access.

Region	States Covered	Total Sites	Tier-1 Hubs	Tier-2 Branch	Tier-3 Remote
North India	Delhi, UP, Haryana, Punjab, Rajasthan, J&K, Himachal	82	3	63	16
West India	Maharashtra, Gujarat, Goa, MP	74	3	56	15
South India	Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Andhra, Telangana	68	3	52	13
East India	West Bengal, Odisha, Bihar, Jharkhand, NE States	49	2	37	10
Central India	Chhattisgarh, Telangana (Central), Vidarbha	27	1	20	6
TOTAL	**28 States / UTs**	**300**	**12**	**228**	**60**

Appendix B — Compliance Matrix Template

Vendors must complete the following compliance matrix and submit it as Appendix H of their proposal. This matrix summarises the vendor's compliance against key mandatory requirements and certifications:

Ref.	Requirement	Status (C/PC/NC)	Evidence Reference	Vendor Comments
CM-01	ISO/IEC 27001:2022 — Vendor organisation	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-02	ISO/IEC 20000-1:2018 — Vendor organisation	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-03	SOC 2 Type II — Cloud-managed service components	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-04	Microsoft Azure ExpressRoute Partner Designation	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

CM-05	AWS Direct Connect Delivery Partner Designation	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-06	India Legal Entity (CIN registration)	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-07	DPDP Act 2023 — Data localisation within India	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Section 5 / Appendix]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-08	SD-WAN OEM Hardware Partner named	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Section 5, TR-005]*	*[Name OEM]*
CM-09	Firewall OEM named for SD-WAN edge NGFW	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Section 5, TR-007]*	*[Name OEM]*
CM-10	SIEM platform named for Managed SOC	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Section 5, TR-014]*	*[Name SIEM]*
CM-11	GSMA eSIM RSP compliance certificate	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix B]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-12	ITIL v4 — SOC Incident and Problem Management	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Section 5, TR-016]*	*[Vendor to fill]*
CM-13	PRINCE2 or PMP certified Project Manager named	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix D]*	*[Name of PM]*
CM-14	Deviations Register submitted as Appendix G	*[C/PC/NC]*	*[Appendix G]*	*[Vendor to fill]*

Appendix C — Pricing Rate Card Layout

The Pricing Rate Card must be submitted as a separate sealed commercial proposal PDF. The rate card must be structured as follows, with all columns completed:

Line #	Item Description	Workstream	Unit Type	NRC (INR)	MRC (INR)	Annual (INR)
[Line #]	[Item description — see Section 10.2]	[SD-WAN / Cloud / SOC / IoT / PS]	[Per site / per device / per SIM / fixed]	*[INR]*	*[INR]*	*[INR]*
...	...	...	...	...	...	...
TOTAL	**TOTAL PROGRAMME TCO (36-month contract value)**	All	Fixed	*[Total NRC]*	*[Total MRC x 36]*	*[Total p.a.]*

Appendix D — Reference Matrix Template

Complete the following for a minimum of two (2) qualifying reference deployments:

Client Name	Industry	Sites Deployed	Go-Live Date	Services Provided	Outcome Metrics	Reference Contact
[Vendor to fill]	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[SD-WAN / Cloud IC / SOC / IoT]*	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Name, Title, Email]*
[Vendor to fill]	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[SD-WAN / Cloud IC / SOC / IoT]*	*[Vendor to fill]*	*[Name, Title, Email]*

— END OF REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL DOCUMENT —

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